

Laurence Hawkins

HEAD OF PLATFORM | ENGINEERING LEADERSHIP | ORGANISATIONAL SCALING

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Engineering and Platform leader with experience building and scaling high-performing technology functions across regulated financial services environments. Experienced in organisational design, leadership development, cloud strategy, FinOps, operational excellence and engineering productivity, with a track record of transforming engineering organisations from single-team operations into multi-layer functions spanning Platform Engineering, Core Services, Calculations, IT Support and Professional Services.

Known for creating autonomous, outcome-focused teams through strong leadership structures, clear ownership models and pragmatic engineering governance. Experienced in leading managers and technical leaders, aligning engineering investment with business priorities, and establishing scalable operating models that support both growth and regulatory requirements.

Delivered measurable commercial impact through cloud cost optimisation programmes achieving 15–20% cost reduction, large-scale platform modernisation initiatives, and the integration of acquired businesses into shared technology and operational frameworks. Combines deep technical credibility across AWS, Azure and cloud-native platforms with a strategic focus on business value, risk reduction, resilience and long-term organisational effectiveness.

Career spans healthcare, telecommunications, cybersecurity and financial services, providing a broad perspective on scaling technology organisations in complex, highly regulated and business-critical environments.

Key Capabilities

Engineering Leadership: Organisational design, leadership development, team scaling

AI Platforms & Governance: Governed AI environments, model-agnostic tooling, usage controls, secure enablement

FinOps & AI Cost Management: Cross-model cost visibility, spend optimisation, usage guardrails, ROI

Platform & Cloud Strategy: Multi-account architecture, cloud governance, developer enablement

Security & Compliance: Access control, data handling, isolation, regulated environments

Technology Integration: Post-acquisition integration, platform consolidation, operating model alignment

Professional Experience

Head of Platform

Wealth Wizards — Nov 2022 – Present

Scope: Leadership of Platform Engineering, Core Services, Calculations, IT Support and Professional Services functions, partnering with the CTO to scale engineering capability across regulated financial services platforms. Direct management of five technical leads leading multidisciplinary engineering teams, with responsibility for a 50+ account AWS estate, platform strategy, cloud and AI governance, technology integration, engineering enablement and AI cost oversight

- Expanded remit from a single Platform Engineering team supporting three AWS accounts to leadership responsibility across five engineering functions and a 50+ account cloud estate, reflecting continued organisational growth and executive trust
 - Defined and led implementation of governed, model-agnostic AI development environments, enabling secure use of AI coding tools within isolated, air-gapped environments while improving control of credentials, browser sessions, source code access and developer governance
 - Led development of an AI cost visibility platform spanning services and tools including Amazon Bedrock and Cursor, providing cross-model usage insight, attribution and improved understanding of AI spend
 - Introduced AI spend guardrails and usage controls to help teams manage consumption proactively, balancing developer productivity, cost efficiency and measurable return on investment
 - Designed and scaled a leadership structure spanning five engineering teams, developing technical leads and establishing operating models that enabled autonomous delivery, clear ownership and organisational scalability
 - Coached engineers on effective AI usage, including model selection, cost-performance trade-offs and how to make informed decisions about when higher-cost models genuinely add value
 - Established FinOps practices across a 50+ account AWS estate, delivering 15–20% cost reduction through infrastructure modernisation, Kubernetes platform optimisation, storage lifecycle management, governance controls and cost visibility improvements while continuing to scale platform capability
 - Led post-acquisition technology integration of Responsible Life, standardising cloud infrastructure, identity management, security controls and engineering practices to reduce operational complexity and support long-term platform consolidation
 - Reduced disaster recovery capability from over 24 hours to under 45 minutes through platform modernisation and resilience improvements
 - Reduced more than 120 critical vulnerabilities through platform modernisation, dependency governance and CI/CD improvements
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Lead SRE

Egress — Nov 2020 – Nov 2022

Scope: Platform reliability and CI/CD ownership for a core product on multi-region Azure Kubernetes infrastructure.

- Automated deployments via CI/CD, reducing release time from days to minutes
 - Reduced out-of-hours incidents from daily to monthly through monitoring improvements
 - Implemented infrastructure as code for scalable, repeatable deployments
 - Mentored engineers and improved operational standards
 - Supported reliable delivery of systems handling customer and operational data
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Senior DevOps Engineer

Plusnet — Sep 2018 – Nov 2020

Scope: Technical lead driving platform modernisation and container adoption.

- Reduced deployment time from 20 minutes to 10 seconds through CI/CD transformation
 - Led migration of monoliths to containerised microservices across teams
 - Introduced centralised support model improving cross-team efficiency
 - Influenced adoption through company-wide presentations
 - Acted as representative for 500+ employees, working with CEO and CTO
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DevOps Engineer & Solutions Architect

FISC — Nov 2016 – Sep 2018

- Built global cloud platform enabling international expansion
 - Migrated services from on-premise to cloud environments
 - Introduced CI/CD, improving delivery speed and reliability
 - Standardised tooling and deployment processes
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Earlier Career

DevOps Engineer — Motortrak (2015–2016)

Operating Department Practitioner — NHS & Private Healthcare (2006–2015)

Professional Development

- Executive Coaching Programme (2025)
 - Leadership development focused on organisational design, leadership capability, succession planning and scaling engineering organisations
 - Ongoing development in cloud strategy, FinOps, AI enablement and engineering productivity
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Education

DipHE Operating Department Practice - London South Bank University